

ContactsFreeShare

How to run the desktop app and use every menu — written in plain language, one feature at a time.

This manual explains how to start ContactsFreeShare and what each menu and page does. You can read it cover to cover, or jump straight to a chapter from the contents below. Throughout, the **menu names** appear in color so they're easy to spot, and figures show you where things are on screen.

CONTENTS

1. Getting started: launching the app
2. The menu bar at a glance
3. Google Connect and the Editor system
4. The ContactsFreeShare menu (About, Settings, Update, Revisions)
5. The File menu: Import, Export, Backup
6. Contacts: the main list
7. Viewing and editing a contact
8. Meeting Data
9. Address Book
10. Field List
11. Pending Edits
12. Edit Lists (history)
13. Share Contacts

14. Settings, explained

15. Words worth knowing (glossary)

Getting started: launching the app

ContactsFreeShare runs on your own computer and shows itself inside your web browser. Nothing is published to the internet; the browser is simply the window the app uses.

To start it, open the **ContactsFreeShare** folder and double-click **Start ContactsFreeShare.command** on a Mac, or **Start ContactsFreeShare** on Windows. (If you installed the Desktop shortcut, you can use that icon instead.) A moment later your browser opens automatically to the address `http://127.0.0.1:8000`, which just means "this computer." If the app is already running, double-clicking again simply brings the existing window forward instead of starting a second copy.

The first screen you land on is **Google Connect**, because almost everything the app does begins with connecting your Google account. We'll cover that in Chapter Three. To close the app, close the browser tab and quit the launcher window.

TIP: WHERE YOUR INFORMATION LIVES

Your contacts, photos, and settings are stored privately on your own computer in a ContactsFreeShare folder (on a Mac, inside *Library* → *Application Support*). They are only sent to Google when you choose to upload — see Chapter Three.

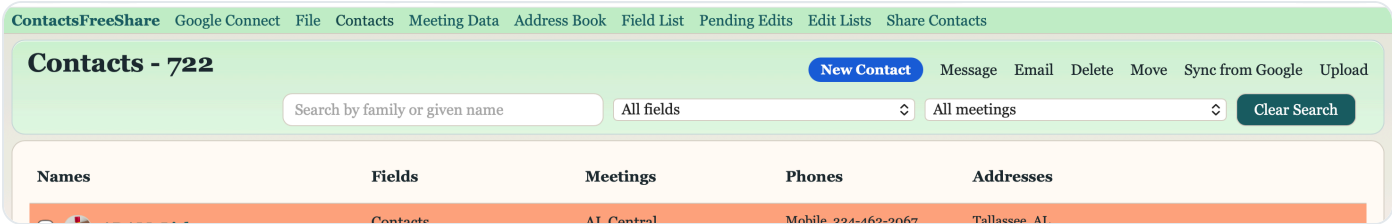


Figure 1. The main window and the menu bar that appears on every page.

The menu bar at a glance

The strip across the top of every page is your map of the whole app. Here is what each item is for; the rest of the manual takes them one by one.

Menu	What it's for
ContactsFreeShare	The app menu — About, Settings, Update App, and App Revisions (Chapter Four).
Google Connect	Sign in to Google, sign in as the Editor, and upload your changes (Chapter Three).
File	Import contacts, export them, and make backups (Chapter Five).
Contacts	The main list of everyone, with search and filters (Chapter Six).
Meeting Data	Printable meeting-directory layouts (Chapter Eight).
Address Book	Design and print a PDF address book (Chapter Nine).
Field List	Build and print custom field/meeting lists (Chapter Ten).
Pending Edits	Change requests waiting to be applied (Chapter Eleven).
Edit Lists	A history of edits made to contacts and meeting data (Chapter Twelve).
Share Contacts	Opens the separate sharing website (Chapter Thirteen). Appears only when you're signed in and allowed to edit.

Some menus are simple links that open a page; others (the **ContactsFreeShare**, **File**, and **Edit Lists** menus) open a small dropdown when you hover or click them.

Google Connect and the Editor system

This is the most important page to understand, because it controls how your contacts move between the app and Google. Its full title on screen is **Google Connect Settings**, and it's where you connect your account, sign in to make changes, and push your work back to Google.

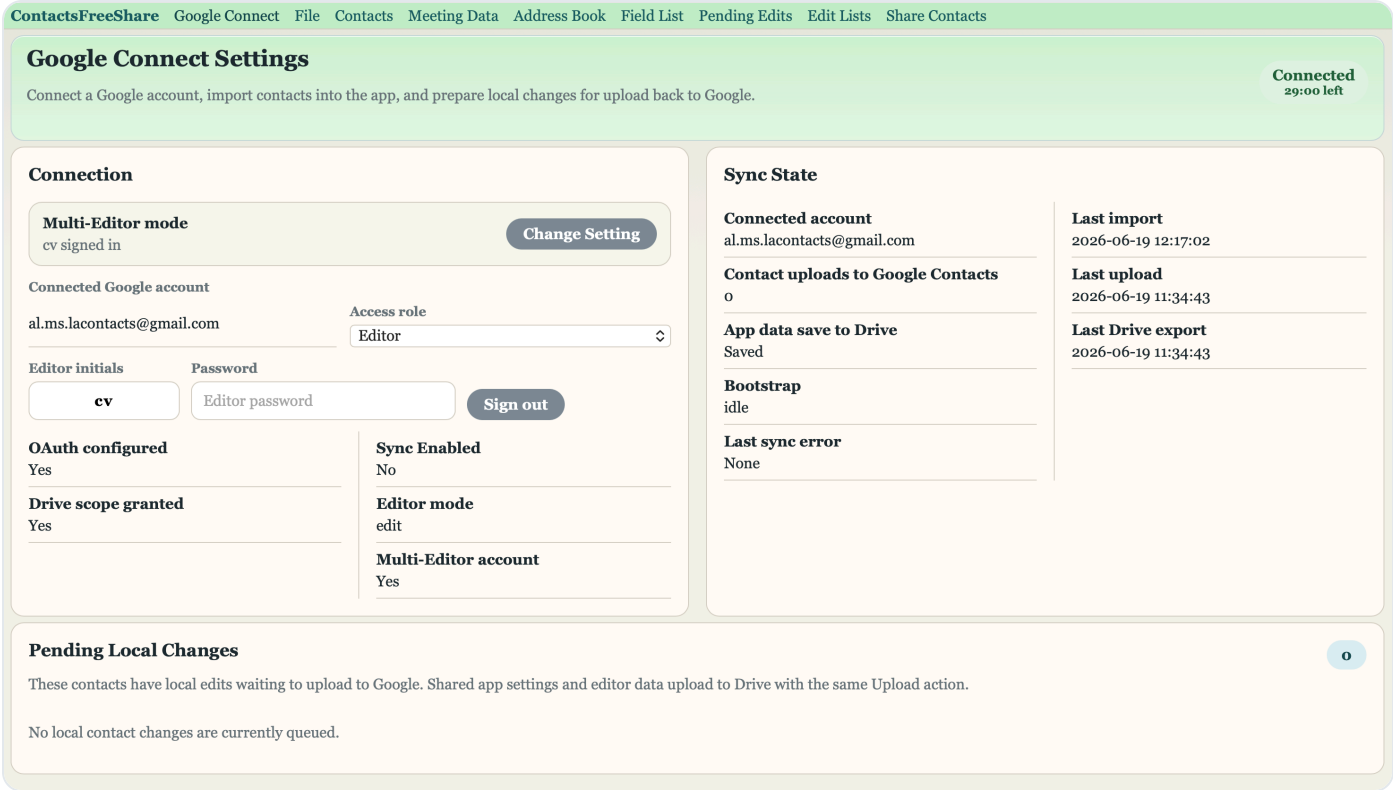


Figure 2. The Google Connect page.

Connecting your Google account

If you're not connected yet, click **Sign In With Google** and approve access in the window that appears. Once connected, a green **Connected** badge is shown. If you ever need to use a different account, use **Reconnect / Switch Account**, and **Disconnect** removes the connection entirely.

One Editor at a time

ContactsFreeShare is built so that several people can share one set of contacts safely. To prevent two people from overwriting each other, only one person can be the **Editor** — the person allowed to make changes — at any moment. Everyone else can still look around in what the app calls **NO-EDIT mode**.

How sign-in looks depends on a single setting (Chapter Fourteen):

- **If the app is set for a single person**, connecting your Google account is all you need; you can edit right away.
- **If the app is set for multiple Editors**, you also choose an **Access role**, type your two-letter **initials**, and — for the full **Editor** role — enter the shared **Editor** password, then click **Sign in**. Lesser roles let helpers work only on the Field List, Address Book, or Pending Edits without touching contacts.

Connection

Multi-Editor mode

cv signed in

Change Setting

Connected Google account

al.ms.lacontacts@gmail.com

Access role

Editor

Editor initials

cv

Password

Editor password

Sign out

OAuth configured

Yes

Drive scope granted

Yes

Sync Enabled

No

Editor mode

edit

Multi-Editor account

Yes

Figure 3. Signing in as the Editor (multi-Editor mode only).

When you sign in as the Editor, the app reserves the "edit lock," pulls down the latest shared information, and lets you make changes. If someone else is already the Editor, you'll see a notice

telling you who it is and how long until their session ends; until then the app stays in NO-EDIT mode. If a previous Editor left without signing out, you may be offered the chance to **Take Over** the stale session.

The Editor time limit

An Editor session lasts a set length of time (you choose it in Settings). Two minutes before it ends, a box titled **Editor Time Almost Up** appears with a countdown. Click **Add 15 minutes** to keep working, or **Sign out** to finish. If the time runs out, the app signs the Editor out for you so the next person can take a turn.

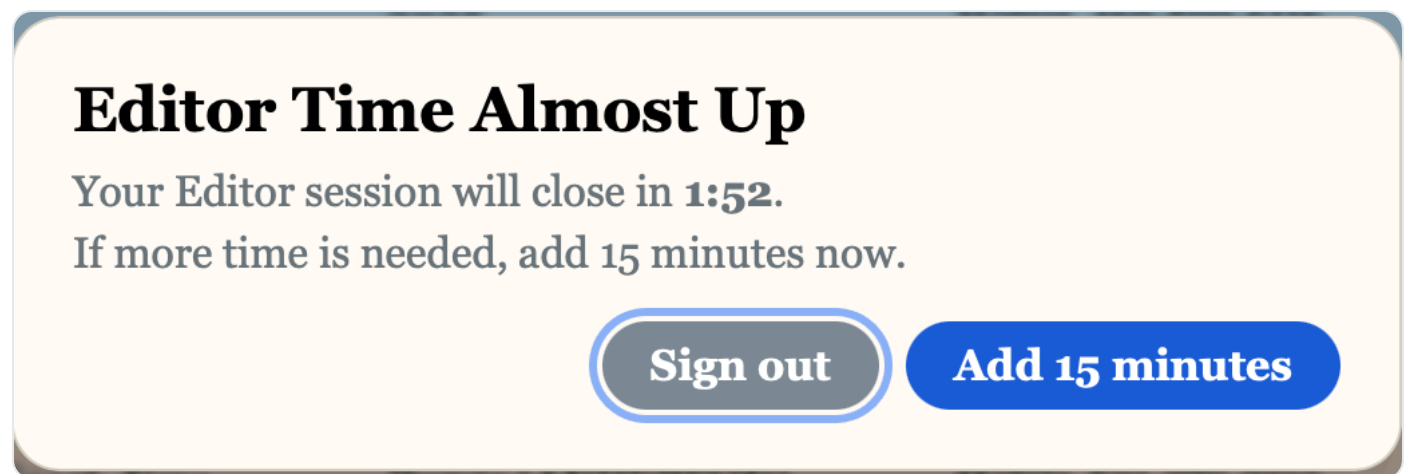


Figure 4. The Editor time-limit warning.

Upload: sending your work to Google

As you edit, your changes are saved on your computer first. When you're ready to publish them, click **Upload** (it appears on both the Google Connect and Contacts pages whenever there's something waiting). Upload sends your contact changes to Google Contacts and saves the shared settings, lists, and layouts to Google Drive. Signing out as the Editor also uploads any pending contact edits before releasing the lock.

The ContactsFreeShare menu

The first menu, named after the app itself, holds four items.

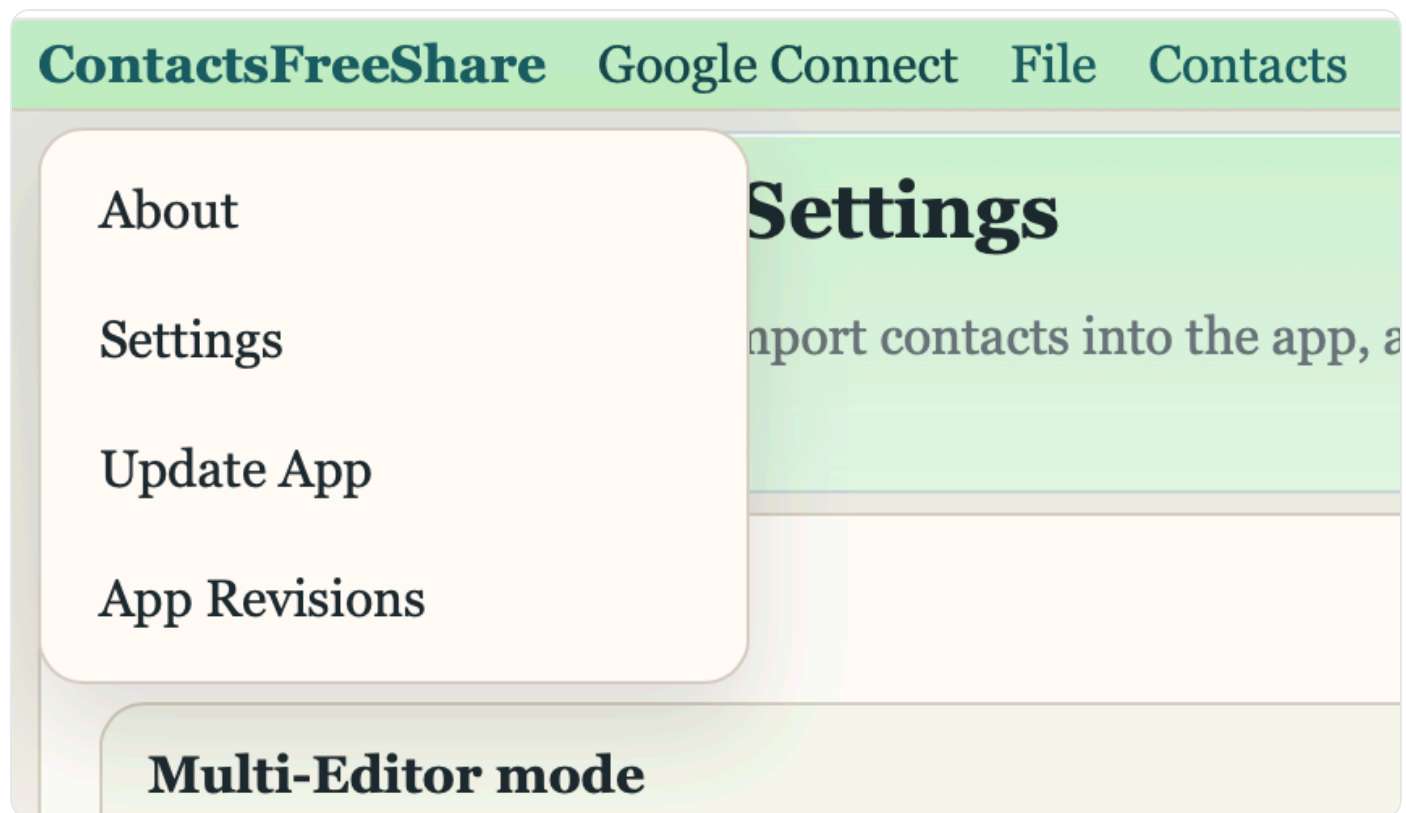


Figure 5. The ContactsFreeShare menu.

About opens a small window showing the app's name and version number — handy if you're ever asked which version you're running.

Settings opens the main settings page, where you control colors, the Editor system, the shared Drive folder, and the connection to the sharing website. Because there's a lot there, it has its own chapter (Chapter Fourteen).

Update App checks whether a newer version of ContactsFreeShare is available. It shows a brief "Checking for updates" message and then takes you to the App Revisions page with the result.

App Revisions shows a dated list of what changed in each version. If an update is available, a panel here lets you **Install** or **Download** the new version. Installing closes the app and replaces it

with the newer one.

The File menu: Import, Export, Backup

The **File** menu is where contacts come in and go out.

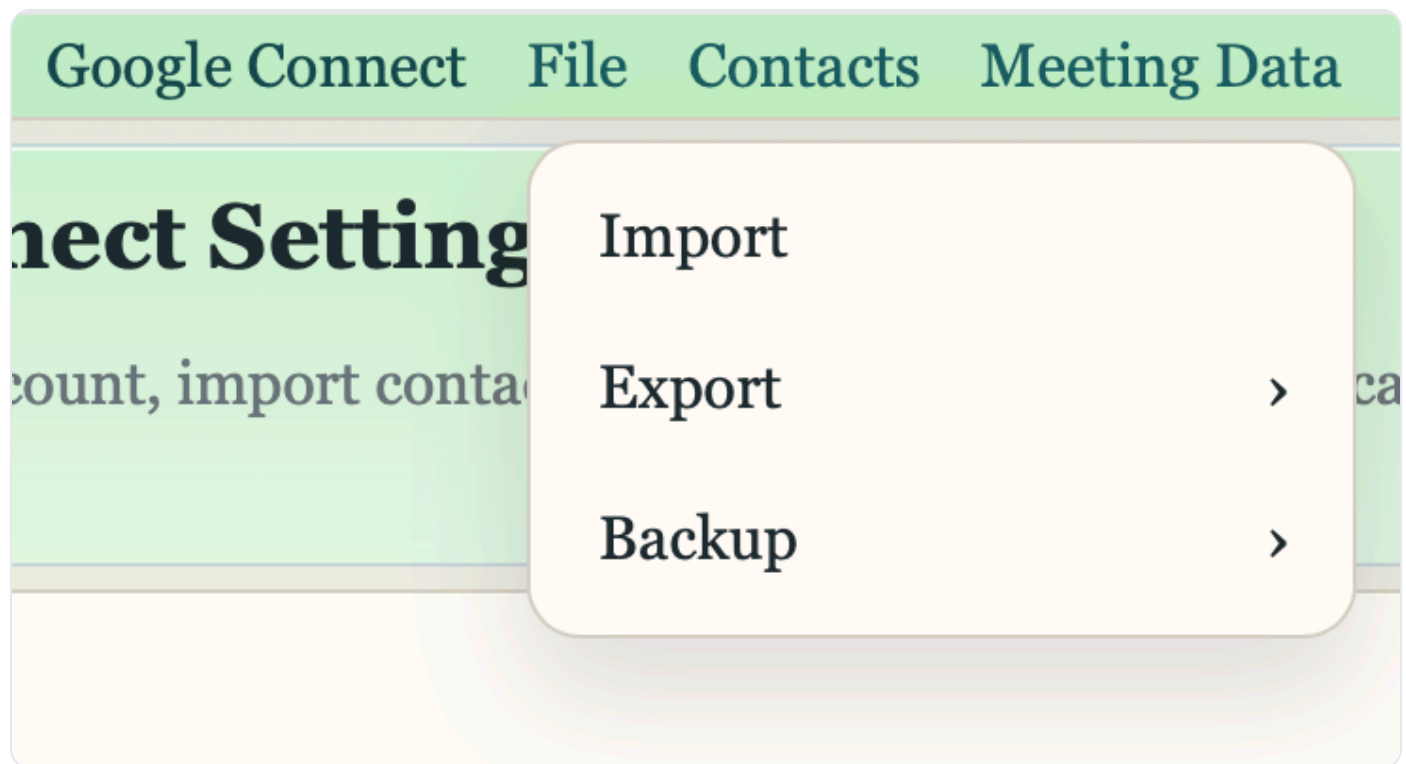


Figure 6. The File menu.

Import

Import opens a page with three choices. **Sync from Google Contacts** is the gentle one: it brings in only the contacts that changed in your Google account and leaves everything else untouched. **Import from Google Contacts** is the heavy one: it erases the app's contacts and replaces them with a fresh copy from Google — useful when starting over, but it asks you to confirm by clicking **Erase App Contacts And Import**. The third choice restores **Contacts** or **MeetingData** from a backup you previously saved in Google Drive.

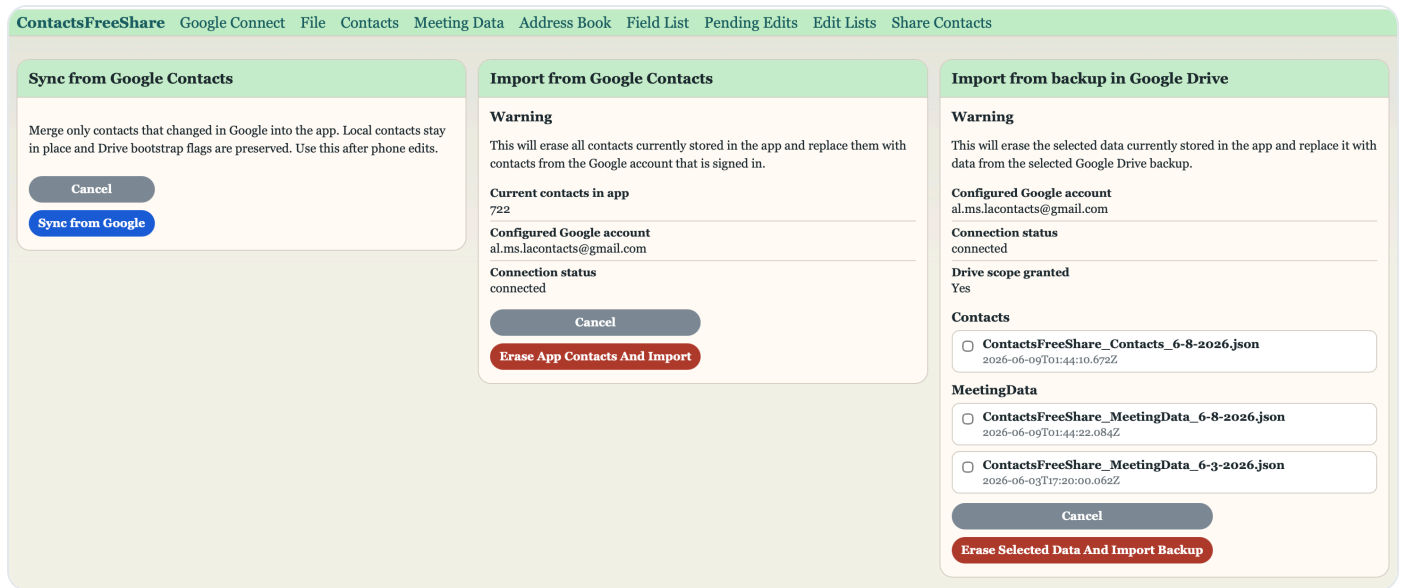


Figure 7. The three ways to bring contacts in.

HEADS-UP

"Import from Google Contacts" and "Erase Selected Data And Import Backup" both *replace* what's in the app. When in doubt, use "Sync from Google Contacts," which only merges changes.

Export

Export saves your contacts to a file. You can choose **App CSV** (a spreadsheet in the app's own format), **Google CSV** (a spreadsheet formatted the way Google likes), or **vCard** (the standard contact-card format that most phones and address books understand). After picking a format, the app asks whether to save it **On This Computer** or **In Google Drive**.

Backup

Backup saves a complete safety copy. You can back up your **Contacts** or your **MeetingData**, and send each either to your computer or to a Backups folder in Google Drive. These are the files the Import page can later restore from.

Contacts: the main list

The **Contacts** page is the heart of the app — the full list of everyone, with the total count shown in the title (for example, **Contacts - 722**). Names are listed alphabetically by family name, then given name.

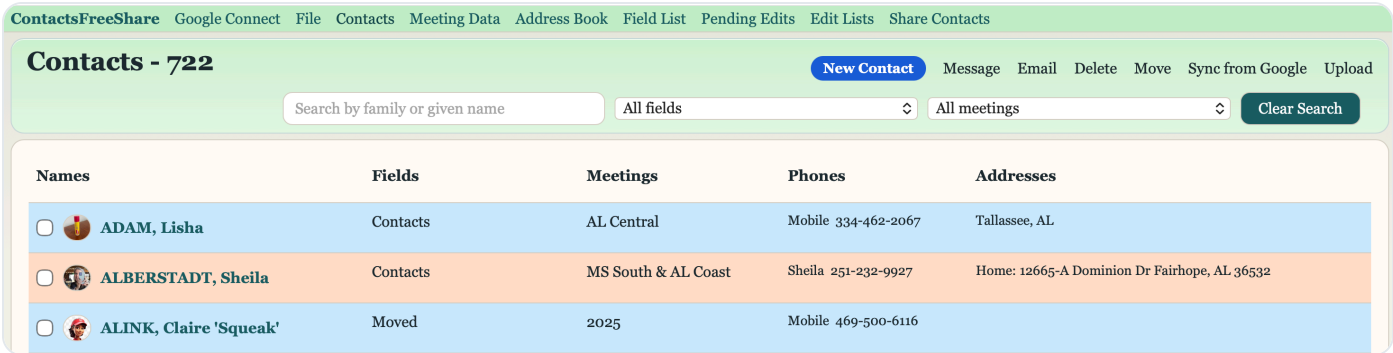


Figure 8. The Contacts list.

Finding people

Type into **Search by family or given name** to narrow the list as you type. The **All fields** and **All meetings** dropdowns let you show only the people in a particular field or meeting; those same dropdowns also let you add, rename, or remove a field or meeting. **Clear Search** resets everything back to the full list.

The action buttons

Across the top you'll find buttons that act on the list or on the people you've checked:

Button	What it does
New Contact	Opens a blank form to add someone.
Message	Texts the selected people using your computer's messaging app.
Email	Starts an email to the selected people.
Delete	Moves the selected people to "Deleted" (and permanently removes them if they're already there).
Move	Moves the selected people to a different field or meeting at once.
Sync from Google	Pulls in recent changes from Google (when connected and editing is allowed).
Upload	Sends your pending changes to Google and Drive.

To select people, use the checkboxes on the left of each row; the **All** and **None** shortcuts help when you want everyone or want to start over. To open a person, just click their row or their name.

Viewing and editing a contact

Clicking a name opens that person's **detail page** — a clean, read-only summary. Phone numbers show call and text icons, email addresses are clickable, and addresses include map links. You'll also see their field and meeting assignments, any notes or custom fields, birthday, and a small Administration panel with technical details like the Google contact ID.

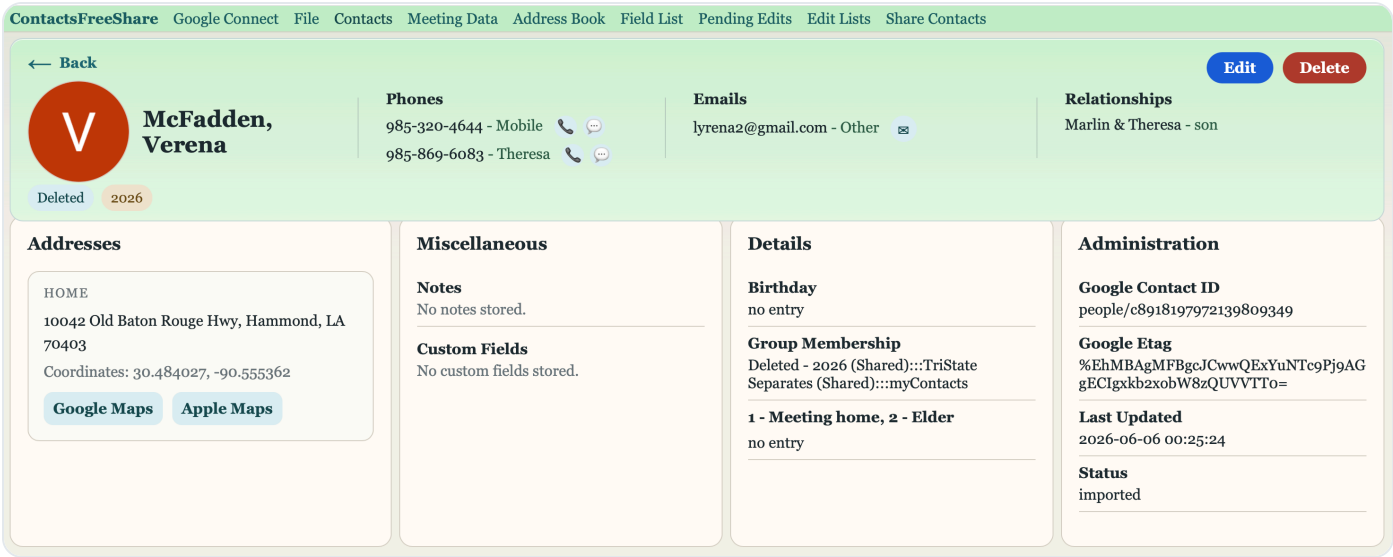


Figure 9. A contact's detail page.

From the detail page, **Edit** opens the form where you change information, and **Delete** moves the person to Deleted. A deleted person shows a **Restore** button so you can bring them back.

The edit form

The edit form is organized into sections. At the top are the name, birthday, and a **Do not Print** checkbox (which keeps someone out of printed books). Below that are repeatable sections for **Phones**, **Emails**, **Addresses**, **Relationships**, **Custom Fields**, and **Notes** — each with an **Add** button to include another and a **Remove** to take one away. Near the bottom are the **Fields** and **Meetings** this person belongs to. When you're done, click **Save Contact**; **Cancel** discards your changes.

ContactsFreeShare
Google Connect
File
Contacts
Meeting Data
Address Book
Field List
Pending Edits
Edit Lists
Share Contacts

← Back
Cancel
Save Contact

Edit Contact

Identity

Family name

Given name

Birthday

1 - Meeting home, 2 - Elder

Address Book/Field List
☐ Do not Print



Upload photo from computer
Max 8 MB. Allowed types: JPG, JPEG, PNG, GIF, WebP.
 no file selected

Photo Location

Phones

Phone	Label	
985-320-4644	Mobile	Remove
Phone	Label	
985-869-6083	Theresa	Remove

Assignments

Fields

Meetings

Group membership

Emails

Email	Label	
lyrenaz@gmail.com	Other	Remove

Custom Fields

Field	
	Remove
Value	

Addresses

Label	Coordinates	
Home	30.484027, -90.555362	Remove
Formatted address	10042 Old Baton Rouge Hwy, Hammond, LA 70403	

Relationships

Name	Type	
Marlin & Theresa	Custom son	Remove

Notes

Notes

Figure 10. Editing a contact.

The photo tool

To add a picture, use **Upload photo from computer**. A **Crop Contact Photo** window opens where you can drag the photo to position it and use the **Zoom** slider to size it; click **Use Crop** when it looks right. For people who already exist in Google, **Upload photo to Google Contacts** sends the picture up with your next upload.

Crop Contact Photo

Drag the image, then use the slider to zoom. The square crop will be used for the circular avatar.



Zoom



Cancel

Use Crop

Figure 11. The photo crop tool.

Moving people

To move several people to a different field or meeting, check them on the Contacts list, click **Move**, choose the destination, and confirm with **Move Contacts**.

Meeting Data

The **Meeting Data** page manages printable meeting-directory layouts, organized by field and meeting. The opening page, titled **MeetingData**, lists each section with how many rows and cells it contains, and the same search and field/meeting filters you know from the Contacts page.

ContactsFreeShareGoogle ConnectFileContactsMeeting DataAddress BookField ListPending EditsEdit ListsShare Contacts

MeetingData

Search by field or meeting name or meeting home name

All fields

All meetings

Field	Meeting	Rows	Cells
AL Central	Birmingham (GRAHAM)	9	7
AL Central	Fosters (REESE)	8	8
AL Central	Marbury (Van HOUTEN)	5	4
AL Central	Opelika (MASK)	3	3
AL North	Anniston (BERRY)	2	2
AL North	Heflin (BRAGG)	11	9
AL North	Madison #1 (EGGER)	5	4

Figure 12. The Meeting Data sections list.

Clicking a section opens the **MeetingData Editor**, a visual canvas that mirrors the printed page. There you arrange rows, adjust the column layout, gap, and font size, choose a **Book Layout**, preview the printed result with **Meeting Print Preview**, and keep your work with **Save Layout**.

Text in row cells below approximate page position. Use Meeting Print Preview to see actual placement

Delete All Rows

Row 1

Order1Kindcontentblankdividercolumn flowunderlinedtable starttable endFont size7.0Insert Blank Row BelowAdd CellDelete Row

12345678910111213141516171819202122232425262728

MoveLGRDaytime Bible Study - 1:00 PMDelete

Row 2

Order2Kindcontentblankdividercolumn flowunderlinedtable starttable endFont size7.0Insert Blank Row BelowAdd CellDelete Row

12345678910111213141516171819202122232425262728

MoveLGRR. Bengtson, V. Graham, J. Morrison, S. Wilson:Delete

Row 3

Order3Kindcontentblankdividercolumn flowunderlinedtable starttable endFont size7.0Insert Blank Row BelowAdd CellDelete Row

12345678910111213141516171819202122232425262728

MoveLGRK. Clark, H. Rhodes, K. Shelton, L. TilleryDelete

Row 4

Order4Kindcontentblankdividercolumn flowunderlinedtable starttable endFont size7.0Insert Blank Row BelowAdd CellDelete Row

12345678910111213141516171819202122232425262728

MoveLGR

Figure 13. The Meeting Data editor.

CHAPTER NINE

Address Book

The **Address Book** page is a design studio for producing a printed PDF address book from your contacts. The left side holds layout choices — page size, fonts, line spacing, and margins — while the middle shows a live preview of how a page will look, and the right side holds printing options.

The screenshot shows the 'Address Book' design studio interface. The top navigation bar includes 'ContactsFreeShare', 'Google Connect', 'File', 'Contacts', 'Meeting Data', 'Address Book', 'Field List', 'Pending Edits', 'Edit Lists', and 'Share Contacts'. The interface is divided into three main sections:

- Left Panel (Layout Choices):**
 - Book Layout:** A dropdown menu set to '3.5x5.5 PDF (Default)'.
 - Preview:** Two dropdown menus for 'All Fields' and 'All Meetings'.
 - Page Size:** Two input fields for 'Width' (set to 3.5) and 'Height' (set to 5.5).
 - Typography:** A 'Font' dropdown set to 'Arial', and 'Size' (set to 7.0) and 'Line spacing' (set to 1.2) input fields.
 - Margins:** Four input fields for 'Left' (0.1), 'Right' (0.1), 'Top' (0.15), and 'Bottom' (0.15).
- Middle Panel (Live Preview):**
 - Address Book:** A header section with 'Layout Name' (3.5x5.5 PDF) and 'Book Title' (AL MS LA). Below it, a preview of the address book page shows a list of contacts with their phone numbers, initials, and names. The list is titled 'All Meetings' and includes entries for GRAHAM, BENGTON, CHAFFINS, CLARK, FIEVET, MORRISON, and NORMAN.
- Right Panel (Printing Options):**
 - Map Links for Addresses:** Radio buttons for 'Google Maps' (selected) and 'Apple Maps'.
 - GPS Coordinates NOT provided:** A checkbox for 'Italicize address'.
 - Address Alignment:** Radio buttons for 'Left aligned' and 'Right aligned' (selected).
 - Print:** Radio buttons for 'Print Fields/Meetings alphabetically' and 'User defined print order' (selected). Below is a 'Print Order' button.
 - Cover picture:** A checkbox for 'Cover picture' and a 'Title' input field.
 - Print PDF:** A large button.
 - Book binding:** Radio buttons for 'Side spiral' (selected), 'Top spiral', and 'Stapled/folded'. Below is a 'Print paper book' button.

Figure 14. Designing the address book.

On the right you can decide whether addresses link to Google or Apple Maps, choose left or right alignment, and pick the printing order — alphabetical or a custom order you arrange by dragging. You can add a cover picture, title, and date, choose how meetings flow onto pages, and finally produce the document with **Print PDF**. There are even binding choices — side spiral, top spiral, or stapled — for **Print paper book**. Layouts you create can be saved and reused.

Field List

The **Field List** page builds simpler printed lists for a particular field or meeting — lighter than the full address book. As with the Address Book, the left sidebar holds page options (one or two columns, address alignment, page numbers, and more), the middle is a builder where you arrange what appears, and the right sidebar controls fonts, sizes, and margins. You can save named templates and print with **Print List**.

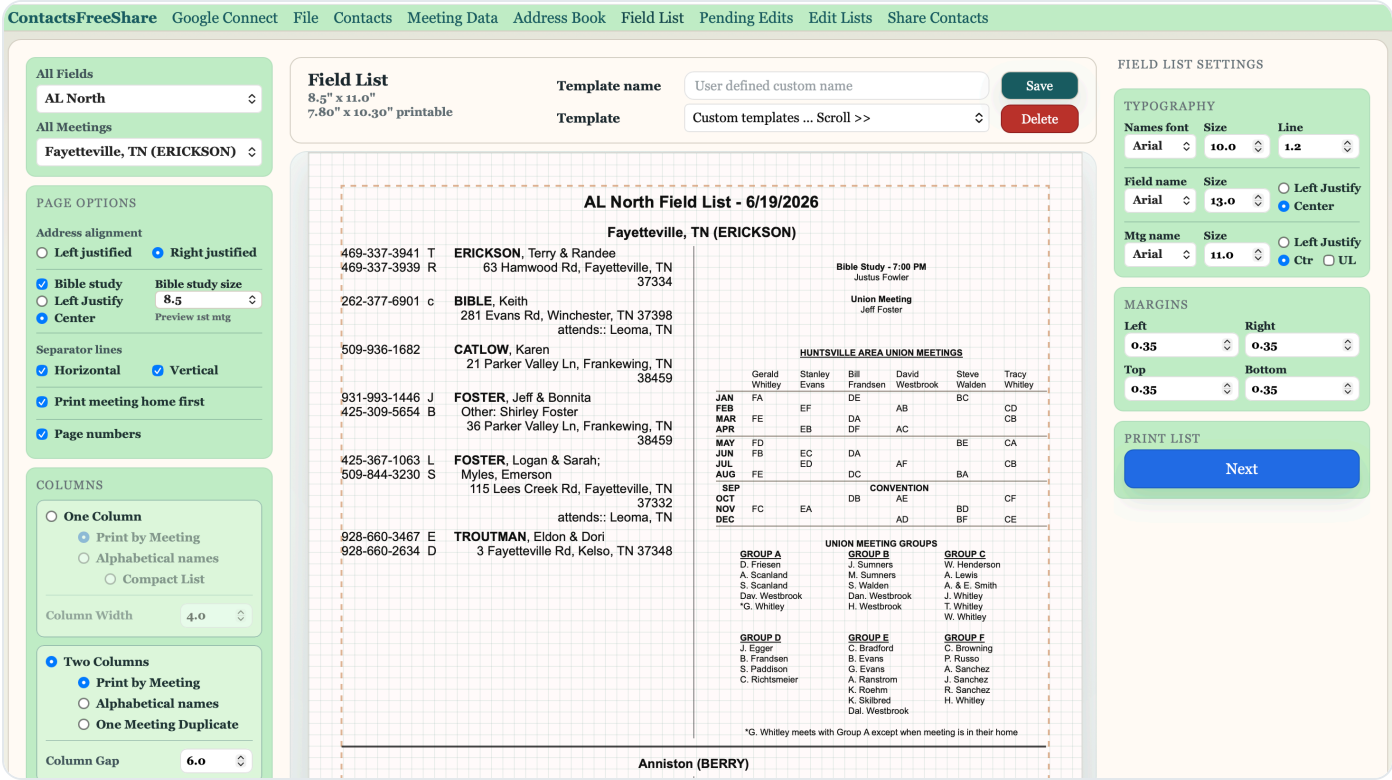


Figure 15. The Field List builder.

Pending Edits

The **Pending Edits** page is a shared list of change requests — often sent in from the mobile app — that the Editor reviews and applies. Each row records the date, the person or event the change is about, and the change itself, and rows save automatically as you type.

ContactsFreeShareGoogle ConnectFileContactsMeeting DataAddress BookField ListPending EditsEdit ListsShare Contacts

Changes for Contacts / MeetingsEnter changes on row 1Download from DriveAdd RowCompleted edit(s)Exit

Automatic Date	Name/Event	Changes
Ck, 06/17/2026, 21:45	Headrick, KEN Open contact edit	Cv - Given name: KEN → Ken
Ck, 06/17/2026, 21:45	Van Houten, VYRON Open contact edit	Cv - Given name: VYRON → Vyron
Ck, 06/17/2026, 21:44	Scanland, SHANE Open contact edit	Cv - Given name: SHANE → Shane
Ck, 06/17/2026, 21:44	Pierce, RODNEY Open contact edit	Cv - Given name: RODNEY → Rodney
Ck, 06/17/2026, 21:43	Whitley, TRACY Open contact edit	Cv - Given name: TRACY → Tracy
Ck, 06/17/2026, 21:43	McEwen, BRODIE Open contact edit	Cv - Given name: BRODIE → Brodie

Figure 16. Pending Edits.

Use **Download from Drive** to pull in requests submitted from phones, **Add Row** to jot a new one, and **Completed edit(s)** to tick off requests you've handled. As with everything else, your changes reach Google Drive the next time you **Upload**.

Edit Lists (history)

The **Edit Lists** menu offers two history pages that record who changed what. The **Contacts Edit List** shows each contact edit with the editor's initials, the contact's name, the field that changed, and the text before and after. The **Meeting Data Edit List** does the same for meeting-directory changes. Clicking an entry jumps you straight to the relevant edit. These pages are read-only — a helpful trail rather than a place to make changes.

ContactsFreeShare Google Connect File Contacts Meeting Data Address Book Field List Pending Edits Edit Lists

Contacts Edit List All edits to contact cards appear below

Editor	ContactName	LabelName	OriginalText	EditedText
CV	Ard, Melissa "Lisa" 6/19/2026, 11:33 AM	Photo Location	https://lh3.googleusercontent.com/cm/AGPWSu8XjdGp9SnoQ-TOzxoRfQ55VCk_YT1gDzgKgKShQKsEYEy7SryMVZggWF2ahS262mSUw=s168	/static/uploads/contact_photos/bec917eec8244119835eadd7c8f2877.jpg
CV	Rieben, Joseph "Joey" 6/18/2026, 5:22 PM	Birthday	blank	1970-06-17
CV	Knaak, Barbara 6/18/2026, 11:27 AM	Photo Location	/static/uploads/contact_photos/551cee2be10e4d5892e4ac628f7f2ca4.jpg	/static/uploads/contact_photos/aoa3a871a93d41f4bc9ef1faeadc90b0.jpg
CV	Headrick, Ken 6/18/2026, 10:43 AM	Given name	KEN	Ken

Figure 18. The Contacts Edit List history page.

Share Contacts

The **Share Contacts** link opens the separate sharing website in a new browser tab — the place where you can share a group of contacts with other people and have your updates delivered to them automatically. It appears in the menu only when you're connected to Google and allowed to edit (in multi-Editor mode, only when you're the signed-in Editor). The website's address and key are set up once under Settings (Chapter Fourteen). Using the sharing site itself is covered in its own separate guide.

Settings, explained

Open **ContactsFreeShare** → **Settings** to reach the page titled **ContactsFreeShare Settings**. When the app is set for multiple Editors, you must be signed in as the Editor to change anything here. Click **Save Settings** when you're done.

ContactsFreeShare

Google Connect

File

Contacts

Meeting Data

Address Book

Field List

Pending Edits

Edit Lists

Share Contacts

ContactsFreeShare Settings

Editor Mode

Will this app be used by multiple Editors?

Yes

This Google account is already set for multiple Editors.

Editor secret

Leave blank to keep current secret

Used only when signing in with the Editor access role.

Editor lock-out time

Hour

Minutes

0

30

Shared folder

Use a shared Google Drive folder for Address Book PDF sharing

Shared folder ID

iFJBkRyh8IPrR8fLJZCJk8X4tkydrRMel

Choose Drive Folder

Choose a folder to grant ContactsFreeShare access, or paste the long folder ID from Google Drive. Use the Shared with me tab for folders another user shared with you.

If Google shows 403 or cannot access your account:
Reconnect Google on the Google Connect page after updating ContactsFreeShare.
In Google Cloud Console, enable the Google Picker API and restrict GOOGLE_PICKER_API_KEY to HTTP referrer http://127.0.0.1:8000/* (plus http://localhost:8000/* if you use localhost).
GOOGLE_PICKER_APP_ID must be your Google Cloud project number, not the OAuth client ID.
Close the Google window, allow third-party cookies for ContactsFreeShare, then choose the folder again.

CONTACTS COLORS

Title Bar Color

#c8focb

Primary Row Color

#c7e8ff

Secondary Row Color

#ffdec7

Cursor Hover Color

#ffa57d

MEETINGDATA COLORS

Title Bar Color

#c8focb

Primary Row Color

#ffdec7

Secondary Row Color

#c7ccff

Cursor Hover Color

#c7fffa

SHARED CONTACTS GROUP

All-Contacts Shared Group Name

TriState Separates (Shared)

Used in Google group membership for every shared field/meeting contact, alongside {Field} - {Meeting} (Shared).

Figure 17. The Settings page.

The settings are grouped into sections:

Section	What it controls
Editor Mode	Whether the app is used by one person or by multiple Editors. Choosing "Yes" turns on the Editor sign-in, password, and one-at-a-time lock described in Chapter Three.
Single-Editor save location	(Single-person mode) Whether edits stay only on this computer, or also go up to Google Contacts and Drive.
Editor secret	(Multi-Editor mode) The password people type to sign in with the full Editor role.
Editor lock-out time	(Multi-Editor mode) How long an Editor session lasts before the time-up warning appears — set in hours and minutes.
Shared folder	The Google Drive folder used to share Address Book PDFs, with a button to choose it.
Share web app	The address and key for the separate sharing website, so the Share Contacts link and automatic recipient updates work.
Contacts Colors	The title-bar, row, and hover colors on the Contacts screens.
MeetingData Colors	The same color choices for the Meeting Data screens.
Shared Contacts Group	The name of the Google group used to hold shared contacts.

Words worth knowing (glossary)

Term	Meaning
Editor	The one person currently allowed to make changes. Only one Editor can be active at a time.
NO-EDIT mode	What everyone else sees while someone else is the Editor — you can look but not change.
Upload	Sending your saved changes up to Google Contacts and Google Drive.
Sync from Google	Bringing in only the contacts that changed in your Google account, without erasing anything.
Import (erase & replace)	Replacing the app's contacts with a fresh copy from Google or a backup.
Field / Meeting	The two ways contacts are grouped throughout the app, used for filtering and printing.
Do not Print	A per-contact switch that keeps someone out of printed books and lists.
Backup	A complete safety copy of your contacts or meeting data, saved to your computer or Drive.

That's the whole app. Keep this manual nearby while you get comfortable — after a week or two, most of it will feel like second nature.